

Changing planet

Planet Earth is always changing. Areas of land (continents) move slowly around on Earth's surface, changing the map of the world. The climate swings from warm to cold, and the plants and animals change from one era to the next, sometimes dramatically. Scientists divide the age of the dinosaurs into three periods, all of which were very different from today's world.



EARTH TODAY

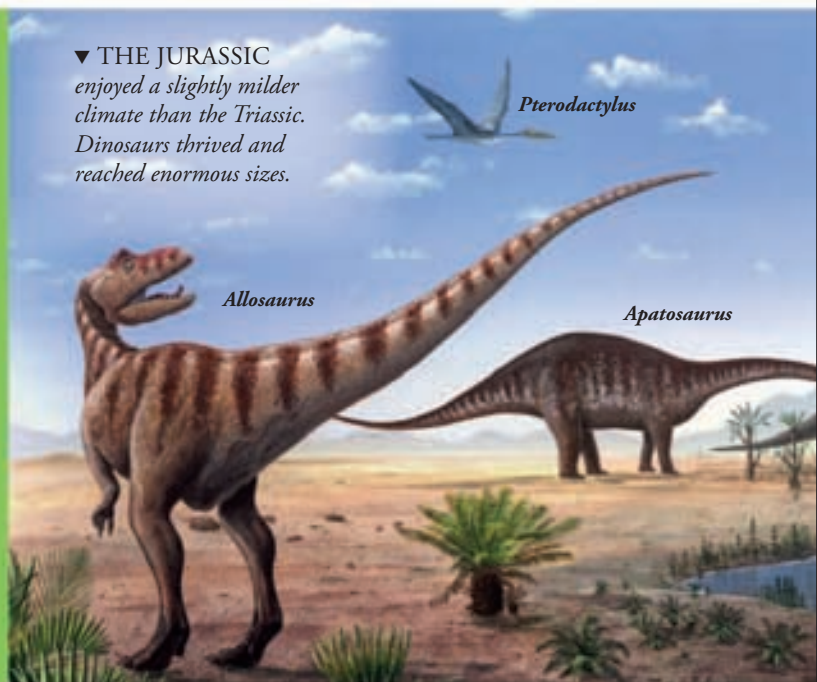
Today Earth's land is divided into seven major areas that we call continents: Europe, Africa, Asia, North America, South America, Antarctica, and Australasia. All the continents are still moving, but very slowly—at about the speed your fingernails grow.

TRIASSIC LIFE



JURASSIC LIFE

▼ THE JURASSIC enjoyed a slightly milder climate than the Triassic. Dinosaurs thrived and reached enormous sizes.



CRETACEOUS LIFE

